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Some Principles of Exchange and Investment among the Tiv¹

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TIV are a pagan people numbering over 800,000 who live in the middle Benue Valley of northern Nigeria. The basis of their economy is subsistence agriculture, supplemented by an effective network of markets particularly in the southern and central portions of their country. Tiv pride themselves on their farming abilities and their subsistence wealth.

Today, however, their ideas of economic exchange and their traditional methods of investment and economic aggrandizement are being undermined by a new economic system which demands different actions, motives and ideas. This article deals with: (I) Tiv ideas of exchange as expressed in their language, (II) some traditional modes of investment and exchange, based on a ranked hierarchy of spheres or categories of exchangeable commodities, and (III) the impact of Western economy on such aspects of subsistence, exchange and investment which Tiv consider in terms of these spheres or categories.

I

Distribution of goods among Tiv falls into two spheres: a "market," on the one hand, and gifts, on the other.

The several words best translated "gift" apply—besides the cases which we in the West would recognize as "gift"—to exchange over a long period of time between persons or groups in a more or less permanent relationship. The gift may be a factor designed to strengthen the relationship, or even to create it. There are several Tiv words for "gift," the examination of which would require another article the length of this one. For our purposes, it is primary that any of these "gift" words implies a relationship between the two parties concerned which is of a permanence and warmth not known in a "market," and hence—though "gifts" should be reciprocal over a long period of time—it is bad form overtly to count and compute and haggle over gifts.

A "market" is a transaction which in itself calls up no long-term personal relationship, and which is therefore to be exploited to as great a degree as possible. In fact, the presence of a previous relationship makes a "good market" impossible: people do not like to sell to kinsmen since it is bad form to demand as high a price from a kinsman as one might from a stranger. Market behavior and kinship behavior are incompatible in a single relationship, and the individual must give way to one or the other.

The word "market" (*kasoa*) has several meanings in Tiv. It refers primarily to any transaction which is differentiated from gift exchange (and, as we shall see, from exchange marriage). It is also a meeting of people at a regular place and time for the primary purpose of exchanging food and other items. One's "market" is also an aspect of one's luck (*ikôl*)—some people have "good market

[luck]" and some have "bad market [luck]." Therefore, one's market can be affected by one's ritual condition, for fetishes (*akombo*)—not to mention witches (*mbatsav*)—can spoil a man's market (*vihi or kasoa*); indeed, curses and broken promises can also affect a person's market.

Everything, including women, which is exchanged has an exchange value or equivalent (*ishe*), whereas no gift has an exchange value. In a market situation *ishe* means vaguely "exchange equivalent"—one might even sometimes translate it "price"—though Tiv seldom ask or quote equivalents in their own trading. Rather, they effect bargains, usually without recourse to this word. An expensive item is a "thing of great value" or "thing of high equivalent" (*kwagh u kehe ishe*), and to haggle is to dispute the value or equivalent (*kperen ishe*). The general term both for economic trading and for exchange marriage can be translated roughly as "trading value" (*yamen ishe*).

In every market transaction, there is a man who sells (*te*) and a man who buys (*yam*). These words must be carefully examined for they do not exactly parallel their English equivalents. *Te* means to spread something out on the ground to the public view, as in a market place. By extension, it means "to sell"—there is no other way to say "to sell," and no other verb to designate that half of an exchange in which one releases or gets rid of an article. *Yam*, on the other hand, means "trade" in the widest sense, but refers primarily to that half of the exchange in which one takes or gains an article. It can, therefore, often be translated by the English word "buy." Its difference, however, can be seen in sentences such as "I bought money with it" (*m yam inyaregh a mi*—more accurately translated "I realized money on it," and still more accurately but less literally, "In this exchange what I received was money"). Activities of traders are called *yamen a yam*; exchange marriage is often called "woman trading" (*kwase yamen*) or, more politely, "value trading" (*ishe yamen*).

Although Tiv have a word which means approximately the same as the English word "exchange" (*musan*), which can sometimes be used to differentiate barter from money transactions, this word is not ordinarily used of trade or commerce.

II

Within the bounds of these words and basic concepts, Tiv image and communicate their ideas of economic transactions and investments. It is important to realize, however, that the ideas themselves may never be articulated as principles or as logical systems. The systematization may be, as in this case, the work of the ethnographer. Yet, this systematization is—or at least is consistent with—the Tiv covert ideology in the matter; its empirical validity is demonstrated when, in terms of it, the ethnographer can both sensibly discuss the ideas and images with Tiv in their language, and communicate them in another language to his colinguals and colleagues.

It is in these terms that we can say that in Tiv ideology it is neither usual nor desirable to exchange a commodity for just any other commodity. Rather,

there are several different categories of interchangeable commodities and items, each of which is felt to be more or less exclusive. It seems to be necessary to distinguish three such categories.

The most apparent category of exchangeable items among Tiv consists primarily of foodstuffs (*yiagh*). All locally produced foodstuffs (imported, particularly European, food is not *yiagh*) are said by Tiv to be of a single economic kind, and immediately interchangeable. To trade pepper for locust-bean sauce or yams for guinea corn is a common transaction or "market" among Tiv. The quantities to be exchanged are never prescribed,² as they are in some societies—the bargain which any individual may drive within the sphere of foodstuffs is a reflection of the market aspect of his luck. If I, selling pepper, can get locust beans of a quality and quantity whose value I myself consider to be greater than the value of the pepper I gave for them, my market is good; if I get less, my market is bad—or, more commonly, the market of the other person is better than mine. The obvious advantage of such a line of reasoning is that, in really successful transactions, everybody's market is good.

Included within this same category are chickens and goats, as well as household utensils (mortars, grindstones, calabashes, baskets and pots) and some tools (particularly those used in agricultural pursuits), and also raw materials for producing any items in the category. For a woman to sell yams to buy a pot, for her to make a pot and sell it to buy yams—these are considered to be normal buying and selling (*yamen a yam*).

The second important category is that which includes slaves, cattle, that type of large white cloth known as *tugudu*, and metal bars. One is still entitled to use the present tense in this case, for ideologically the category still exists in spite of the fact that brass rods are today very rare, and that slavery has been legally abolished. Tiv still quote prices of slaves in cows and brass rods, and of cattle in brass rods and *tugudu* cloths. Akiga, in a hitherto untranslated part of his book, tells us that,

You could buy one iron bar (*sokpo*) for a *tugudu* cloth. In those days five *tugudu* cloths were equivalent to a bull! A cow was worth ten *tugudu*. One brass rod (*bashi*) was worth about the same as one *tugudu* cloth; thus five brass rods were worth a bull.

Other Tiv would disagree about the actual values of these various commodities.³ The value of the brass rod is said by all to have declined considerably just before the arrival of Europeans in Tivland. None, however, would disagree with Akiga's grouping of commodities.

This second category is associated with prestige (*shagba*) in the same way that the first category is associated with subsistence. Although slaves and brass rods, at least, had some economic value beyond their value as prestige-conferring property, this latter was their main use.

The supreme and unique category of exchange values contains only one item: rights in human beings other than slaves, and particularly rights in women. Even twenty-five years after official abolition of exchange marriage, it is this category of exchange in which Tiv are emotionally most entangled

(L. and P. Bohannan 1953: 69–71). All exchanges within this category are exchanges of rights in human beings, usually dependent women and children, so that the category may be called the category of dependent persons, and many of its values are expressed in terms of kinship and marriage.

This plan or scheme leaves out several important items of Tiv material culture: particularly weapons, specialists' tools like divining apparatus, etc., which do not, generally speaking, enter into exchange situations. Since I have no record of hearing these items discussed in a situation of exchange, I have no basis for assigning them to one category or another—indeed, I doubt that Tiv would do so. My purpose in reporting these categories is not the pedantic one of putting every commodity into one or the other; rather, the categories represent the fundamentals of Tiv notions of exchange and investment.

Further, several items which we consider as exchangeable wealth, and as bases for investment, are not included by Tiv in this system of thought. Services and labor, for example, are by and large reciprocal and form part of the age-set, kinship and domestic group structures and moralities. Tiv consider it rude and improper to discuss services in terms of "exchange" but insist rather that such matters be viewed as individual acts of generosity or as kinship or age-set obligations. They recognize the reciprocity, of course, but do not themselves cast it into terms which we would consider "economic." Land, which many peoples—including, perhaps, ourselves—consider to be the ultimate wealth, is not exchangeable among Tiv, not even for other land. Land is, to Tiv, the spatial aspect of social organization; land rights are conditions of agnation. It is impossible for a Tiv to invest in land, since his basic right in land is a right to sufficient land, and only secondarily a right to specific lands. No Tiv can control more land than he can use. (Both land rights and labor are discussed at some length in Bohannan 1954.) Therefore, it should be noted, we are dealing with Tiv exchange and investment, but Tiv notions cover only a part of the range to which the English words "exchange" and "investment" refer.

It is instructive of Tiv modes of thought about these three main categories of exchangeable items to note the manner in which individual items can be "removed" from the categories, or made incapable of further exchange. Individual items are removed from the category of subsistence by expenditure, including sacrifice to fetishes. Although yams have an exchange value as well as a utilitarian value, once eaten they no longer have either. Household equipment breaks or is worn out. All items which are removed from this sphere of exchangeable goods are removed either by being used up or by being sacrificed (and subsequently used up).

Removing individual items from the second category—that centering around prestige—is more complex, and its very complexity makes possible some of the characteristics of Tiv economy. Some individual items—cloth—can be removed by expenditure; other individual items—slaves—can be removed by death of human beings. Most of the items, however, are removed by an act which increases the prestige of the owner of the item by diminishing

its utility or exchangeability. Thus, brass rods can be converted into jewelry, thereby increasing the prestige of ownership but diminishing the range of utility; cows can be butchered on festive occasions (cattle are never sacrificed for religious purposes among Tiv), thereby increasing the prestige of the owner but diminishing the utility of the commodity and nullifying its exchangeability.

Individual items are removed from the third category—that of rights in dependent persons—by death of the human beings, and by death alone.

The three chief categories of exchangeable items among Tiv, while considered of equal practical importance, are nevertheless arranged in a hierarchy on the basis of moral values. The category of prestige is superior to (but no more important than) the category of subsistence; great prestige assumes adequate or ample subsistence means. The category of dependent persons is superior to (but no more important than) the categories both of prestige and of subsistence. A large number of dependent persons, demonstrating success in attracting, getting, and keeping dependents, assumes adequate or ample prestige and subsistence goods. But, conversely, many dependents give one prestige and enable one to produce ample and generous amounts of subsistence wealth.

The moral basis of the hierarchy is evident in the fact that the ethics of kinship are more compelling than the ethics of mere prestige (and always take precedence—ideally one must always sacrifice prestige or hope of gain to aid a kinsman); the ethics of prestige are more compelling than the mores of markets and exchange of subsistence wealth—a man forgoes gain in subsistence wealth for the sake of prestige or to fulfill kinship obligations.

The hierarchal nature of the values involved in the three main categories of exchangeable goods provides a basis for investment and economic endeavor in Tiv society. The drive toward success leads most Tiv, to the greatest possible extent, to convert food into prestige items; to convert prestige items into dependents—wives and children. Tiv say that it is good (*do kwagh*) to trade food for brass rods, but that it is bad (*vihi kwagh*) to trade brass rods for food; that it is good to trade your cows or brass rods for a wife, but very bad to trade your marriage ward for cows or brass rods. Seen from the individual's point of view, it is profitable and possible to invest one's wealth only if one converts it into a higher category: to convert subsistence wealth into prestige wealth and both into women is the aim of the economic endeavor of individual Tiv.

That Tiv do conceptualize exchange articles as belonging to different categories, and that they rank the categories on a moral basis, gives rise to the fact that two different kinds of exchanges may be recognized: exchanges of items contained within a single category, and exchanges of items belonging to different categories. For Tiv, these two different types of exchange are marked by separate and distinct moral attitudes.

Exchanges within a category—particularly that of subsistence, the only one intact today—excite no moral judgments beyond comments regarding the “market” luck of one or both of the parties to the exchange. Exchanges between categories, however, excite a completely different sort of moral reaction: the man who exchanges lower category goods for higher category goods does not

brag about his market luck but about his skill in investment, his personal magnetism, and his "strong heart." The man who exchanges high category goods for lower rationalizes his action in terms of high-valued motivation (most often the needs of his kinsmen).

To maintain this distinction between the two types of exchanges which Tiv mark by different behavior and different values, I shall use separate words. I shall call those exchanges of items within a single category "conveyances" and those exchanges of items from one category to another "conversions." (Steiner [1954] uses "translations" for what I have called conversions.) For purposes of analysis, I shall maintain the dichotomy between the two words representing types of exchanges more rigidly than would any Tiv between the two types of moral behavior in the normal course of living. Roughly, conveyances are—to Tiv—morally neutral; conversions have a strong moral quality in their rationalization.

The two institutions most intimately connected with conveyance are markets and marriage, particularly exchange marriage. Both these are special subjects and must be dealt with separately. The remainder of this section is concerned with conversion.

Conversion, unlike conveyance, is not mere exchange of equivalent goods. Because there is a definite moral dimension to conversion, it forms a strong source of motivation to individual action. It is in the light of such motivation that we must evaluate the fact that a very high percentage of autobiographies collected from Tiv contain variants of this story: "When I was a very small child, my kinsman gave me a baby chicken. I tended it carefully and when it grew up it laid eggs and hatched out more chickens; I exchanged these chickens for a young nanny goat, who bore kids, which I put out with various kinsmen until I could exchange them for a cow. The cow bore calves, and eventually I was able to sell the calves and procure a wife." Every successful man considers such a story one of the most important sequences of his biography; it proves that he has been successful.

Tiv say that it was often possible in the old days to buy brass rods for food, but usually only if the owner of the brass rods were short of food or required an unusually large amount to give a feast, making too heavy a drain on his wives' food supplies. They also say that no honorable man would exchange slaves for food—there were other means of getting food, especially along the extended web of kinship. Although all Tiv with whom I discussed the matter denied emphatically that Tiv would ever sell a kinsman, wife or ward to get food (there are other reasons for which such sales were made), Akiga—in an untranslated section of his book—mentions a famine which was so severe that, as a last resort, men sold their daughters to foreigners in exchange for food so that they could keep their sons alive.

Another conversion found among Tiv is marriage by bride wealth (which may be of several types, usually all lumped together and called *kem kwase*). Although some forms of marriage by bride wealth were in the past actually delayed exchanges (and today can be seen as substitutes for exchanges [L. and P. Bohannan 1953:71–73]), to "receive a woman" (*ngoho kwase*)—to get

wife or marriage ward without giving one in exchange—is every man's goal. A wife is traditionally acquired by being granted a sister or cousin (any woman in one's marriage-ward sharing group—the *ingôl* group of Akiga 1939 and Abraham 1940) to exchange for a wife, either directly or by means of bride wealth. A wife whom one acquires in any other way is not the concern of one's marriage-ward sharing group because the woman or other property exchanged for her did not belong to the marriage-ward group. The daughters of such a wife are not divided among the members of a man's marriage-ward group, but only among his sons. Such a wife is not only indicative of a man's ability and success financially and personally, but rights in her are the only form of property which is not ethically subject to the demands of his agnates.

Wives may sometimes be acquired by means of much more elaborate conversions. We discovered one case (in the course of a witchcraft moot) in which a man two generations ago had traded a slave for a cow, which he in turn traded for a marriage-ward to exchange for a wife; the distribution, as marriage-wards, of the daughters of this marriage (among his sons rather than his marriage-ward group) was called into question. Sometimes Tiv acquire foreign wives for cattle, from tribes whose custom it is to marry with cattle; the daughters of such women are considered to be Tiv, and can be exchanged in regular Tiv fashion—they do not go into the "pool" of wards in the marriage-ward group unless a man's agnates force him by threats of witchcraft to share his "property" with them.

There are many social sanctions for conversion of one's wealth to higher categories: Tiv are very scornful of a man who is merely rich in subsistence goods (or, today, in money); they say that if he has not converted his goods the reasons must be personal inadequacy. Tiv also say that jealous kinsmen of a rich man will bewitch him and his people by means of certain fetishes in order to make him expend his wealth in sacrifices to "repair" the fetishes. Once the conversion is made, demands of kinsmen are no longer effective—at least, they must take a new form.

A man who persists in a policy of converting his wealth into higher categories instead of letting it be dispersed by his dependents and kinsmen is said to have a "strong heart" (*taver shima*). He is both feared and respected: because he is strong enough to resist the excessive demands of his kinsmen, but still fulfills his kinship obligations generously, he is feared as a man of special, potentially evil, talents (*tsav*).

III

Tiv notions of exchange and investment are among the hardest hit of all their ideas by impact of Western ideology and by colonial economy and social organization because these ideas are immediately and obviously in conflict with Western ideas and practice. Today, Tiv are concerned because their categories of exchangeable items cannot be maintained. There are three main reasons for this fact: (1) two of the categories today have no overt validity, (2) many new commodities have been introduced which do not belong to any

category, and (3) money has provided a common denominator among the categories which was previously lacking.

A moment's consideration makes it obvious that the category of prestige goods, centering mainly about cattle, slaves and brass rods, has ceased to exist in material terms; although the category is maintained ideally. Slave dealing was prohibited from the first effective European control (about 1910); brass rods are no longer generally available because the Administration regarded them primarily as currency and "replaced" them with pounds, shillings and pence. Perhaps of even greater moment was the fact that in 1927 the highest exchange category, that of rights in women, was dealt a crippling blow by Administrative abolition of exchange marriage and substitution of marriage by bride wealth (payable in money) as the legal form. The category of subsistence items is the only one that today can still be found in anything like its original form.

European and African traders have introduced many new commodities to Tivland, both of Nigerian and European manufacture, and have increased many fold the quantity of some other commodities which were formerly present in small amounts or small numbers. These goods, particularly European goods, were introduced concurrently with money, and they are considered part of the money complex. They do not enter into any formerly existing category, but form their own category only very imperfectly. Thus, there are today many more commodities than ever before which do not fit precisely into traditionally structured exchange situations.

Finally, and perhaps more important, is the introduction of currency, the very nature of which is to standardize the exchangeability value of every item to a common scale. The introduction of currency was not only to be expected with the extension of Western economic ventures, it was hurried by the Administration in its desire to collect tax in a convenient and readily transportable form. A money tax, payable by all adult males, was imposed throughout Tivland by the end of the first World War. Imposition of this tax coincided with the initiation of large-scale growing of beniseed (*sesamum indicum*) as a cash crop. Beniseed, although long known to Tiv, is today often called by the word for "tax" or "tribute" (*kṗandegh*).

Even though it is possible to consider brass rods as "currency" in the old system, because they were a commodity whose exchange value was more far-reaching than that of any other commodity and because they belonged to the intermediary category, the introduction of coinage was not a simple "substitution" of one form of currency for another as was thought at the time to be the case. Brass rods were, it is true, the main medium of conversion in the old days: brass rods could be and sometimes were used to buy food, they could be and often were used to get a wife. But the penetrability of brass rods into the other categories of exchange, while more pronounced than that of any other commodity, did have limitations. Brass rods never provided a standard gauge against which the exchangeability value of all commodities was reckoned, as is the case with the coinage issued by the West African Currency Board.

Today all conversions and most conveyances are made in terms of money.

Yet Tiv constantly express their distrust of money. They compare the monetary system to the subsistence system at great length, always to the disfavor of the former. Money does not (they say) reproduce itself or bear seed. You spend (*vihi*, literally "spoil") money and it's gone—a man can't spend a field, and though he sacrifices a goat, it has already borne kids. Money, they feel, is the root of much of their trouble.

Tiv, both desiring and distrusting money as they do, have attempted at least in some contexts to relegate it to a fourth and lowest category of exchangeable goods. The logical end of such a classification, however, would be either that money is exchanged only for money, or that it is exchanged only for those European goods which were introduced more or less concurrently with it. This is precisely the view that many Tiv elders expound. It is a view, however, which cannot be maintained in the present situation in Tivland.

Concurrently with the introduction of money, pacification of the countryside and introduction of cash crops, a further factor arose: men's trading developed very rapidly. Men's trade, like women's, tends to be based on subsistence goods, but unlike women's, on goods which must be procured and traded over long distances: smoked fish from the Benue and Katsina Ala Rivers, camwood and kolas from Ogoja Province, and items such as cotton which are grown in some parts of Tivland and not in others. Today men up to the age of forty may carry their goods as much as 150 miles to market where it commands the highest price. This trade is usually carried out in terms of money, by semiprofessional traders. These men start with money and end with money; their purpose is to increase their money. Tiv consider this legitimate enterprise.

Tiv also say that women's trade is legitimate and sensible: a woman may sell one type of food to buy another, or sell food to buy a waist cloth for herself or small gifts and latter-day necessities for her children. All Tiv say that the fact that these transactions are carried out in money is beside the point: the woman has not made a conversion, for she has sold expendable subsistence goods and bought expendable subsistence goods.

The difficulty arises when the semiprofessional traders begin trading in the foodstuffs which were formerly the province solely of women. These men may invest sums of their capital in food for resale; in fact, these young semiprofessional traders are the most active buyers and sellers of grain at Tiv markets today, although women also speculate in grain and in yams to a smaller extent. A young trader buys grain in small quantities—often in two- and three-penny lots—from women who are selling it in the market. He collects this grain, may hold it for a while and almost certainly will transport it to another market for sale either to another middleman or to the Hausa or Ibo lorry drivers who visit the larger markets to buy food for export to the overpopulated areas of the Eastern Provinces or the new urban areas in Tivland.

Both the trade carried on by women and that carried on by these ambitious young professional traders are considered admirable by Tiv. The trader is not granted so favorable a position in Tiv society as he is in some other West African societies, and mere monetary or subsistence wealth is not sufficient in

itself to afford great prestige. Trade of women stays within the category of subsistence (if one considers the end in view and discounts the presence of money, as Tiv do in the situation), while the trade of the professionals stays within the monetary category.

Yet Tiv see truckload after truckload of foodstuffs driven away from their large markets every fifth day. They say that food is less plentiful today than it was in the past, though more land is being farmed. Tiv elders deplore this situation and know what is happening, but they do not know just where to fix the blame. In attempts to do something about it, they sometimes announce that no women are to sell any food at all. But when their wives disobey them, men do not really feel that they were wrong to have done so. Tiv sometimes discriminate against non-Tiv traders in attempts to stop export of food, but their actions are seldom upheld by the courts to which the outsiders scurry, and in any case Tiv themselves are occupied in the export of food. In their condemnation of the situation which is depriving them of their food faster than they are able to increase production, Tiv elders always curse money itself. It is money which, as the instrument for selling one's life subsistence, is responsible for the worsened situation—money and the Europeans who brought it.

Yet they cannot fix the blame or stop the situation. When women sell to middlemen, Tiv class this exchange in the category of subsistence exchange. When middlemen sell to other middlemen or exporters, it falls within the ethics of money trade. That the two spheres have overlapped they find mysterious and frustrating, and in the nature of money. Yet, so long as a woman does not sell too much food, there is no feeling that she has done wrong; so long as a man buys a commodity with money and sells it for money, he has done nothing blameworthy.

Of even greater concern to Tiv is the influence money has had on marriage institutions, by affecting the interchange of rights in women. In response to what appeared superficially to be popular demand, the Administration (encouraged by the Missions and with the apparent concurrence of the tribal councils) abolished exchange marriage and substituted for it a form of marriage by bride wealth. It is the writer's opinion that both Tiv and Administration today believe this action to have been precipitate and ill-advised. Today every woman's guardian, in accepting money as bride wealth, feels that he is converting down. Although attempts are made to spend money which is received in bride wealth to acquire brides for one's self and one's sons, it is in the nature of money, Tiv insist, that this is most difficult to accomplish. The good man still spends his bride wealth receipts for brides—but good men are not so numerous as would be desirable. Tiv deplore the fact that they are required to "sell" (*te*) their daughters and "buy" (*yam*, but more euphemistically *kem*, to accumulate) wives. It smacks, they tell the investigator in low tones, of slavery. There is no dignity in it since the possibility of converting a bride-wealth marriage into an exchange marriage has been removed.

The fact that Tiv, in the face of the introduction of a money economy, have retained the motivations commensurate with their old ideology of invest-

ment based on a scheme of the discreteness of several categories of exchangeable items, hierarchically arranged, has created several difficulties and inconsistencies. It is considered admirable to invest one's wealth in wives and children—the least expendable form of wealth traditionally known to Tiv, and that form most productive of further wealth.

But Tiv have come upon a simple paradox: today it is easy to sell subsistence goods for money to buy prestige articles and women, thereby aggrandizing oneself at a rapid rate. The food so sold is exported, decreasing the amount of subsistence goods available for consumption. On the other hand, the number of women is limited. The result is that bride wealth gets higher—the price of women becomes inflated. Under these conditions, as Tiv attempt to become more and more wealthy in people, they are merely selling more and more of their foodstuffs and subsistence goods, leaving less and less for their own consumption.

Indigenous Tiv ideas of the sort we would call economic not only formed a basis for their intellectual ordering of their economic exchanges, but also supply motivation for their personal economic striving. These ideas are inconsistent with a monetary economy on the fringe of industrial society. Tiv, to whom these are not “economic ideas” but a “natural” ordering of phenomena and behavior, tend to see the difficulty as being with the monetary economy. The ethnographer can only look on and attempt to understand the ideas and motivations, knowing that the discrepancy between ideas and the actual situation will become greater until one is smashed and then adapted to suit the other—and he knows also that the conclusion is foregone.

NOTES

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² This fact may be a function of the time observations were made, which was a time of inflation in Tivland as elsewhere.

³ I believe Akiga to be giving examples of a category rather than quoting prices here. But the price stability may have been generally recognized in the pre-money days of stable exchange to which Akiga refers.

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